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a fertilized and ripened ovary. The branch of horticulture that deals with the study of fruits and their cultivation is called **pomology**.

4.7.1 Structure of Fruit

Fruit has a fruit wall. It is otherwise called **pericarp**. It is differentiated into outer **epicarp**, middle **mesocarp** and inner **endocarp**. The inner part of the fruit is occupied by the seed.

4.7.2 Types of Fruit

Fruits are classified into various types:

Simple Fruits

The fruits are derived from a single ovary of a flower Example: Mango, Tomato. Simple fruits are classified based on the nature of pericarp as follows

A. Fleshy Fruit

The fruits are derived from single pistil where the pericarp is fleshy, succulent and differentiated into epicarp, mesocarp and endocarp. It is subdivided into the following.

a) Berry: Fruit develops from bicarpellary or multicarpellary, syncarpous ovary. Here the epicarp is thin, the mesocarp and endocarp remain undifferentiated. They form a pulp in which the seeds are embedded. Example: Tomato, Date Palm, Grapes, Brinjal.

b) Drupe: Fruit develops from monocarpellary, superior ovary. It is usually one seeded. Pericarp is differentiated into outer skinny epicarp, fleshy and pulpy mesocarp and hard and stony endocarp around the seed. Example: Mango, Coconut.

c) Pepo: Fruit develops from tricarpellary inferior ovary. Pericarp terns leathery or woody which encloses, fleshy mesocarp and smooth endocarp. Example: Cucumber, Watermelon, Bottle gourd, Pumpkin.

d) Hesperidium: Fruit develops from multicarpellary, multilocular, syncarpous,

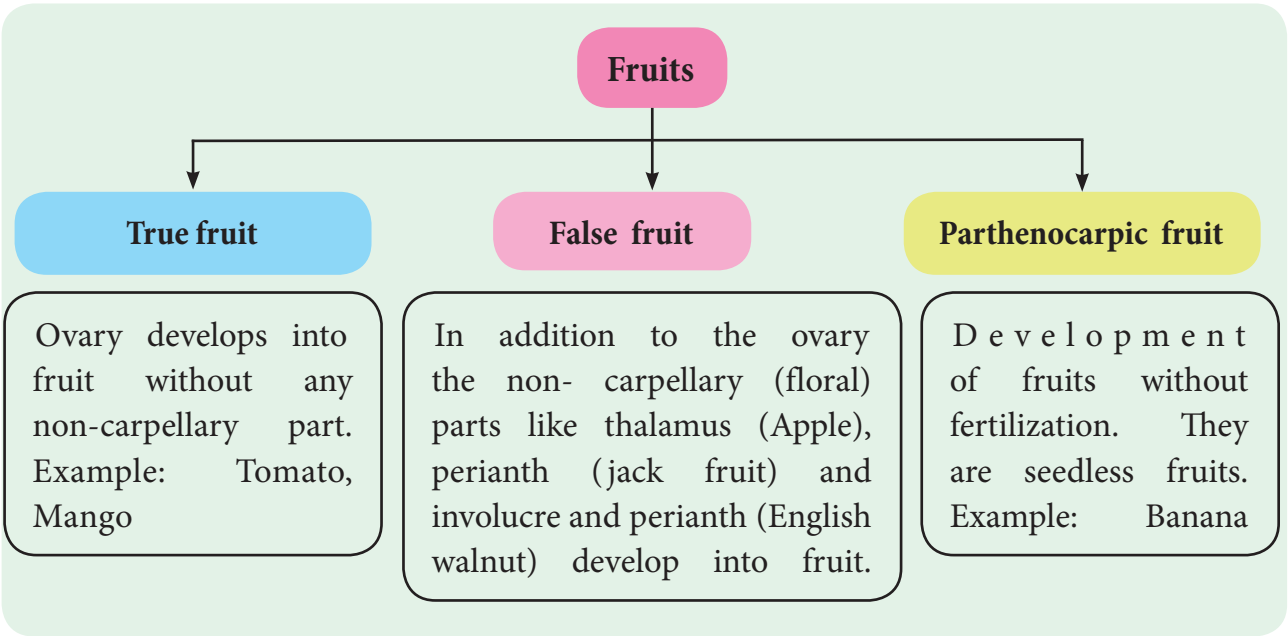

Figure 4.39: Classification of fruits based on formation